Sprint Review and Retrospective: SNHU Travel Application

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Course: CS 250: Software Development Lifecycle
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Date: 10/18/2026

Introduction

ChadaTech is a company that has been using the Waterfall method to develop software but is now moving toward Agile development using Scrum. The company is working on an application for SNHU Travel, a travel agency that wants to reach more customers and improve its services. This project shows how Agile can help a team work together, handle changes, and improve a product over time. Sprint reviews and retrospectives are important parts of this process because they allow the team to look at its progress, get feedback, and figure out what it can do better in the future.

Applying Scrum Roles

Scrum has three main accountabilities: the Product Owner, the Scrum Master, and the Developers. Each role has different responsibilities, but they all work together to help the team complete the project (Schwaber & Sutherland, 2020).

The Product Owner is responsible for deciding which features are most important. For the SNHU Travel application, this could include searching for travel destinations, comparing travel packages, and viewing booking information. The Product Owner also communicates with stakeholders to make sure the team is working on features that customers actually need.

The Scrum Master helps the team follow Scrum and works to remove problems that could slow down progress. For example, if the team is confused about a requirement, the Scrum Master can help arrange a discussion so everyone understands what needs to be done. The Scrum Master also encourages communication and helps the team stay focused on its goals.

The Developers are responsible for building and testing the application. They work together to complete user stories and make sure the features meet the team's requirements. Good teamwork is important because one problem can affect other parts of the project. When everyone understands their responsibilities, the team has a better chance of completing useful work and meeting its goals.

Completing User Stories and Following the SDLC

User stories help explain what a customer wants from a product and why the feature is important. For example, a user story for SNHU Travel could be, "As a traveler, I want to search for destinations by location and travel dates so that I can find a trip that fits my plans."

Once the team has a user story, it can break the work into smaller tasks. These tasks might include creating the search page, allowing users to enter travel dates, displaying matching destinations, and testing the search results. The team should also decide what needs to happen for the story to be considered complete. This helps prevent confusion and makes it easier to check whether the feature works correctly.

Agile development uses an ongoing process instead of trying to finish every stage of the project before moving to the next one. The team plans a sprint, works on selected features, tests the results, and gets feedback. It then uses what it learned to plan future work. This allows the team to find problems earlier and make improvements before the project is finished.

For the SNHU Travel application, this approach would be helpful because customers might change their minds about certain features or request new ones. Instead of waiting until the entire application is complete, the team can show working features to stakeholders and make changes when needed. Mishra and Alzoubi (2023) explain that different software development approaches have different strengths, so teams should consider the needs of their projects when choosing a method.

Handling Interruptions and Changing Requirements

Interruptions and changing requirements can make software development more difficult. A team might run into technical problems, discover a serious bug, or receive a request for a new feature. If the team does not communicate well, these situations can lead to missed deadlines and confusion about what should be completed first.

The first step should be to discuss the problem and determine how urgent it is. The Product Owner can help decide whether a new request is important enough to change the order of the work. The Developers can explain how the change might affect the project, and the Scrum Master can help the team work through any obstacles.

Not every new request needs to be handled immediately. Some changes can be added to the Product Backlog and completed in a future sprint. This helps the team stay focused instead of constantly switching between tasks. If a major change makes the Sprint Goal no longer useful, the Product Owner can cancel the sprint. Otherwise, the team should try to manage the change without losing focus on its current goal.

One of the benefits of Agile is that it allows teams to respond to change. However, that does not mean the team should accept every request without considering the impact. Good

communication and planning help the team decide what needs attention first. The DORA (2024) report also discusses software delivery practices and the importance of understanding how teams work and deliver value to users.

Communication and Organizational Tools

Communication is important because it helps team members understand what needs to be done and what others are working on. If team members do not share information, they may misunderstand requirements or spend time doing the same work twice. Regular communication can help prevent these problems.

Scrum includes several meetings that help the team stay organized. During sprint planning, the team decides what work it will focus on. Daily Scrum meetings help Developers discuss progress and adjust their plans. The sprint review gives stakeholders an opportunity to see the completed work and provide feedback. The retrospective allows the team to talk about what went well and what could be improved.

Organizational tools can also make the development process easier. For example, the team could use Jira or Trello to track user stories, assign tasks, and see which items are complete or still in progress. A shared document could be used to record decisions, requirements, and feedback. These tools help everyone stay on the same page.

However, using a tool is not enough by itself. Team members still need to communicate and keep information updated. When the team combines regular discussions with an organized task board, it becomes easier to identify problems and keep the project moving forward.

Evaluating the Scrum-Agile Process

I believe Scrum is a good choice for the SNHU Travel application because the project may involve changing customer needs and new ideas. Travel customers may want different features, and stakeholders might not know exactly what they need until they see the application being developed. Scrum gives the team opportunities to collect feedback and make improvements throughout the project.

One advantage of Scrum is that the team can focus on smaller pieces of work instead of trying to complete everything at once. For example, the team could first develop a destination search feature, test it, and get feedback before working on more advanced booking features. This would help the team discover problems earlier and avoid spending too much time developing features that do not meet customer needs.

Sprint reviews and retrospectives are also useful because they help the team learn from its work. During a sprint review, the team can show what it has completed and hear what stakeholders

think. During a retrospective, team members can discuss problems with communication, planning, or completing tasks. They can then agree on changes to try during the next sprint.

The team should look at more than just how many tasks it completes. It should also consider whether features work correctly, whether stakeholders are satisfied, how many defects remain, and whether the team is making progress toward its goals. These details provide a better understanding of how well the project is going.

Overall, Scrum seems like a good fit for this project because it supports teamwork, regular feedback, and continuous improvement. Waterfall can still be useful for projects with very stable requirements, but Scrum gives the SNHU Travel team more flexibility when changes are needed. The most important thing is to use the development approach that best fits the project's needs.

Conclusion

The SNHU Travel application is a good example of how Agile and Scrum can help a software development team organize its work and respond to changes. The Product Owner focuses on customer needs, the Scrum Master helps the team work effectively, and the Developers build and test the application. User stories help turn customer requests into smaller tasks, while Scrum meetings give the team opportunities to plan, review progress, and make improvements.

ChadaTech can benefit from using Scrum because it allows the company to receive feedback throughout development instead of waiting until the end of the project. However, the approach will only be successful if the team communicates clearly, keeps its work organized, and takes time to learn from mistakes. By using sprint reviews and retrospectives consistently, the team can improve its process and create a better application for SNHU Travel.

References

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